



**MURRY
STREET
MEDIA**

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Small Business Digital Starter Kit

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Before you launch social media channels, you need to lay down your digital foundation. Think of this phase as building your storefront before inviting people to the grand opening. Starting here guarantees you own your data, look highly professional from day one, and don't lose customers due to broken links.

What?	Why?	How?
1. Custom Domain & Professional Email	First impressions are unchangeable. Sending a business proposal from johnsroofing@gmail.com looks like a hobby. Sending it from john@johnsroofing.com looks like an established, trusted operation. It costs very little but immediately changes how much customers are willing to pay you.	Link to step-by-step how to
2. Google Business Profile & Local Maps (Formally Google My Business)	This is where buyers go when they are ready to spend money today. People don't search Instagram for "plumber near me open now"—they search Google Maps. Getting verified here ensures you show up at the exact moment a customer has their wallet out.	Link to step-by-step how to
3. A Simple Landing Page / Website	You cannot build a house on rented land. Social media platforms change their algorithms overnight, and your visibility can plummet. A website is the only piece of digital real estate that <i>you completely own</i> . It acts as your 24/7 digital salesperson, holding all your reviews, services, and contact info in one permanent place.	One of the easiest DIY website builders out there is wix.com Go Daddy also has a great web builder within their system.
4. LinkedIn	Even if you sell directly to consumers (B2C), a polished LinkedIn page is vital. It's where banks look when you apply for a business loan, where top talent looks when you want to hire, and where other business owners find you for local B2B partnerships or corporate contracts.	How to create a LinkedIn Page

5. Instagram	Instagram is your living, breathing proof-of-life. Customers use it to see the "behind the scenes," check out your recent work, and message you informally. If Google proves you are a <i>real</i> business, Instagram proves you are a <i>likable</i> business.	How to create an Instagram Business account .
6. Facebook Business Page	Millions of users still treat Facebook as their primary local directory. It allows you to join local community groups, share neighborhood updates, and is an absolute requirement if you ever want to run highly targeted local ads in the future.	How to create a Facebook Business Page

Custom Domain & Professional Email

First impressions are unchangeable. Sending a business proposal from johnsroofing@gmail.com looks like a hobby. Sending it from john@johnsroofing.com looks like an established, trusted operation. It costs very little but immediately changes how much customers are willing to pay you.

Option 1: Buy one from Google

1. Choose Your Provider & Check Availability: Time: 5 mins.
 - a. Go to workspace.google.com and click *Get Started*.
 - b. When it asks, "*Does your business have a domain?*", select "No, I need one."
Type in your ideal business name.
 - c. Google will instantly show you what top-level domains (like [.com](#), [.net](#), or [.co](#)) are available and how much they cost per year (usually around \$12–\$20)
2. Create Your Administrative Account: Time: 5 mins.
 - a. Once you select an available domain, you will be prompted to create your primary username.
 - i. Best Practice: Choose a clean format like [hello@yourbusiness.com](#), [contact@](#), or [firstname@](#).
 - *Note:* This first email address will act as your "Admin" account, which you will use to manage billing or add future employees.
3. Secure the Subscriptions: Time: 5 mins.
 - a. You will check out and pay for two things at once:
 - i. The Domain Registration: An annual fee to own the name.
 - ii. The Google Workspace Plan: A monthly per-user fee (the *Business Starter* plan is usually all a small business needs to get a professional Gmail box, Google Drive storage, and Calendar).
4. Complete the ICANN Verification: Crucial Step!
 - a. Right after purchasing, check the *alternate/personal* email address you used during signup. You will receive a critical verification email from the domain registrar (Squarespace/Google).
 - b. You must click the link in this email to verify your contact info within 15 days, or they will temporarily suspend your new domain.

Option 2: Purchase URL from Go Daddy and Connect to Google

Before they start, tell them to open two browser tabs: one signed into their GoDaddy account, and one ready to go on Google.

1. **Start Setup on Google Workspace:**Time: 5 mins.
 - Go to workspace.google.com. Click *Get Started* and fill out the basic business info.
 - When it asks, *"Does your business have a domain?"*, click "Yes, I have one that I can use."
 - Type in the exact domain name purchased from GoDaddy and proceed to create the first username (e.g., info@yourdomain.com).
2. **Trigger the Domain Verification:**Time: 2 mins.
 - Once the account is created, Google will log the user into the Google Admin Console and say, *"Let's set up your domain."*
 - Click Verify. Google's system will automatically detect that the domain is hosted at GoDaddy and will show a button that says "Verify with Domain Host" or "Sign in to GoDaddy." Click it.
3. **Authorize the Secure Link:**Time: 2 mins.
 - A pop-up window will appear asking them to log into GoDaddy (if they aren't already).
 - Once logged in, GoDaddy will display a message asking for permission to connect to Google Workspace. Click Connect or Authorize. Google and GoDaddy will talk to each other in the background and verify ownership instantly.
4. **Activate Gmail (Route the MX Records):**Critical Action.
 - Verifying ownership proves the business owns the domain, but it doesn't turn on the email yet.
 - Back in the Google Admin Console, click Activate Gmail.
 - Google will once again ask to route records automatically via GoDaddy.
 - Click Authorize one more time. GoDaddy will automatically add the MX (Mail Exchanger) records, which act like a digital post office telling the internet to send emails to Google instead of GoDaddy.

****Note** systems update regularly therefore steps may have changed since these instructions were written. Go Daddy and Google both have great customer support options.*

Google Business Profile & Local Maps

Before you begin, have your **exact business name, phone number, physical address (or service areas), and 3–5 high-quality photos** ready to go.

1. **Log In and Search Your Business Name:** Time: 3 mins.
 - Go to **business.google.com** and log in using the professional Google Workspace email you just set up.
 - Type the business name into the search bar. If the business already populates from public data records, click **"Claim this business."** If nothing shows up, click **"Add your business to Google."**
2. **Select Your Business Type:** Critical Choice.
 - Google will ask how you serve customers. This dictates whether your home address stays private:
 - **Online Retail:** No physical store, everything is shipped.
 - **Local Storefront (Brick & Mortar):** Customers come to your physical address (e.g., retail shop, bakery, office). *You must enter an exact address.*
 - **Service Area Business (SAB):** You travel to your customers (e.g., plumbers, mobile detailers, consultants). *Google will hide your physical address and ask you to select delivery zip codes or counties instead.*
3. **Choose Your Primary Category:** SEO Impact.
 - Type your industry and select from Google's dropdown menu.
 - **Rule of Thumb:** Your primary category should describe *what your business is*, not what it sells. For example, choose *"Italian Restaurant"* rather than just *"Restaurant,"* or *"Personal Injury Attorney"* instead of just *"Lawyer."* (You can add secondary categories later).
4. **Submit for Verification:** The Bottle Neck.
 - a. Google must prove the business is legitimate before showing it to the public. Google automatically chooses the verification method for the user based on their industry.
 - **Video Verification (The New Standard):** Google will ask the user to record a continuous phone video showing their street signs, their workspace/tools, and proof of management (like unlocking the door or opening a business software dashboard).
 - **Postcard:** Google mails a physical postcard with a 5-digit code to the address. It takes 5–14 days to arrive.

Optimization: How to Manage the Live Profile

Once verified, the business owner manages the listing directly on Google. You can simply type **"my business"** into the Google Search bar or open the **Google Maps app**, tap your profile icon, and select **"Your Business Profile."**

Fill out these three sections immediately to begin ranking in the "Map Pack":

1. The 750-Character Description

Lead with exactly what the business does, who you serve, and what city you are located in. Avoid spammy sales pitches like "the absolute best cheap plumber in town," as Google's AI reviewers may reject or flag the text. Keep it professional and natural.

2. The Initial Photo Dump

Profiles with rich photo coverage get significantly more clicks and direction requests. Upload **at least 10 high-resolution photos** spanning these specific categories:

- **Exterior:** So customers can easily recognize the building from the street.
- **Interior:** Showing the vibe, cleanliness, or office layout.
- **The Team:** Highlighting the real faces behind the business to build immediate human trust.
- **Action Shots:** The team actively performing the service or creating the product.

3. Generate the Review Link

Under the management dashboard, click the button that says **"Get more reviews."** This generates a short, custom [`\[https://g.page/\]\(https://g.page/\)`](https://g.page/) link. Instruct the business owner to save this link to their phone notes. They should text or email this exact link to every happy customer moving forward—reviews are the primary driver of map ranking position.

Crucial Suspension Warning for the Kit

Never to stuff extra keywords into their official business name field to try to game the system (e.g., naming the profile *"John's Plumbing | Best Plumber Dallas Fort Worth"* instead of just *"John's Plumbing"*). Google actively suspends profiles for this, and getting a suspended profile reinstated can take weeks of back-and-forth paperwork.

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